

TRADESPACE

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Applying for: Innovation Director, Skysong Innovations, Arizona State University, Scottsdale, AZ

SUMMARY

Commercialization infrastructure built for turning a university's invention portfolio into ventures and licenses, not just filings. Built around the same mission Skysong states publicly: the rapid, wide dissemination of a university's discoveries into the marketplace, with the triage and matching work done before a venture team's time gets spent on it.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Invention Capture & Portfolio Buildout, Enveda Biosciences *Series B biotech · small legal team, high R&D velocity*

- Replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with AI-assisted intake that meets inventors where they already work: the direct equivalent of pulling patentable work out of engineers who don't recognize it as inventive.
- Migrated the full legacy portfolio in 30 minutes and became the IP team's system of record from day one, with no separate change-management project required.
- Gave a newly onboarded IP team member a working command center instead of a dependency on outside counsel for basic status checks, called “game-changing” from the first login.

Portfolio Strategy & Board Reporting, Woodward *industrial hardware manufacturer*

- Built patent-to-product mapping and board-ready KPI reporting for a hardware manufacturer transitioning off a legacy docketing system, the same “which three patents protect the core product” question every platform and prosecution effort ultimately has to answer.
- Selected over competing IPMS platforms specifically for configurability and fit with the client's existing product-lifecycle process, rather than for the AI drafting capability that later became the differentiator.

CORE CAPABILITIES MAPPED TO THIS ROLE

- Commercialization-readiness triage: flags which inventions in the portfolio have real market demand versus which don't, the same call a venture program has to make before committing mentorship, funding, or a founder's time to an idea.
- Licensee and industry-partner discovery: a network of 20M licensing contacts with partner-specific outreach materials generated in about an hour, so connecting an ASU lab to an outside company or a new venture doesn't start from a cold list every time.
- Portfolio-to-venture pipeline visibility: tracks disclosures, IP status, and licensing activity in one place, the kind of visibility tied to as much as a 15% increase in licensing revenue at institutions using it.

WHERE I STOP

Mentoring a founder through their first term sheet, deciding which faculty inventor is ready to become a startup CEO, and building the venture programs themselves, that's judgment and relationship-building I don't have and don't claim to. What I can do is make sure the portfolio triage and industry-matching underneath those programs isn't the thing eating the hours that judgment needs.